

Editorial

Welcome to the Fourth Wave

Alvin Toffler's Third Wave is receding. Or is it? Conventional wisdom would say no. Toffler's First and Second Waves — the agrarian and industrial economies — are long over, and it is the information society that defines this age.

Stock markets react more sharply to Wipro's fortunes than a cement major's; software exports touched Rs 80,000 crore last year, three per cent of India's GDP; there are more cellphones than landlines in several Indian cities; and laptops are no longer being bought only by jet-setting executives.

Yet, it is becoming increasingly evident that the Third Wave is now making way for the Fourth. Not because technology is no longer relevant, but because it has stopped fascinating us. We are used to it, we take it for granted, but most importantly, we want to know how to use it best.

Therefore, the Fourth Wave will not be *about* technology, but *how* we exploit it.

Consequently, more than ever before, we are being subtly pushed into understanding what technology's new manifestations are, and master them. It is these avatars you shall see in *Digit* from now.

They will reflect how we — post-modernist children of a society travelling at hyperspeed — take a pause and look at technology. We always knew we interacted with technology, but could never put a finger on how we did it. *Digit* has made an attempt to do just that.

You will find stories that thrill, inform, educate, and entertain. 'Enter' launches you quickly into the magazine, at the pace you are used to when playing *NFS Underground* — furiously fast.

It progresses to 'Digital Passion', with stories that fuel the pursuit of technology knowledge; of people who hold technology dear to their hearts.

The 'make-technology-work-for-me' feel is reflected in 'Digital Tools', with articles that place you ahead of your peers at the workplace, or otherwise. It is replete with tools that maximise your productivity, and is aimed at the individual as well as the SoHo segments.

Naturally, then, the next stop is 'Digital Business' — tools to maximise returns on investment and cut costs to give muscle to the bottom-line of small and medium businesses, a segment

Photo: Mexy Xavier



Sachin Kalbag Executive Editor

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that holds tremendous promise. We finally leave you with 'Digital Leisure', to understand how technology has permeated our lives beyond the workplace. This is where you relax, and spend some quality time with technology, having fun all the while.

You can then hit 'Esc', the perfect exit to the magazine, and one that leaves a sweet after taste, just like dessert after a hearty meal.

When you read the new *Digit*, you may realise that the Fourth Wave was always upon us, only we never realised it. It is a thought that may make us smile, and if it does, we just may have a great time ahead together.

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